

Abdullah Ishaq

Law Student · Researcher · Legal Technology Enthusiast

Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, Osun State, Nigeria | [linkedin.com/in/abdullahishaq01](#) | [github.com/unusualhabibi](#) | [reflectionsandrants.substack.com](#)

PROFILE

Law student at Obafemi Awolowo University (Class of 2023) with research interests at the intersection of technology, policy, and regulation. Specialising in intellectual property, data privacy, alternative dispute resolution, energy law, and the governance of artificial intelligence and Web3. Experienced through legal internships at Clifford Chance and Mastercard. Committed to producing rigorous, accessible legal analysis for Africa's most consequential regulatory challenges.

EDUCATION

Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife

LL.B (Hons) — Faculty of Law
2023 – Present

One of Nigeria's foremost law faculties, known for rigorous doctrinal training and a strong tradition of public law scholarship.

LEGAL INTERNSHIPS

Clifford Chance

Legal Intern
[Month Year] – [Month Year]

Gained exposure to international commercial legal practice at one of the world's leading law firms. Areas of work included [update with your actual tasks — e.g. corporate transactions, regulatory compliance, dispute resolution support].

Mastercard

Legal Intern
[Month Year] – [Month Year]

Supported the in-house legal team on matters relating to [update with your actual work — e.g. payments regulation, data privacy compliance, commercial contracts] within Mastercard's operations.

CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

WIPO Academy — DL-101: General Course on Intellectual Property

World Intellectual Property Organization
2023

GDPR Fundamentals Certificate

FutureLearn — Data Protection & Privacy Law
2023

ICSID Arbitration Rules Masterclass

Investor-State Dispute Settlement — Online
2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Intellectual Property Law — copyright, trademark, and digital IP in African jurisdictions
- Data Privacy & Protection — NDPA 2023, GDPR, surveillance law, and cross-border data transfers
- Alternative Dispute Resolution — commercial arbitration (LCA, ICSID), mediation, and ODR
- Energy Law — PIA 2021, electricity regulation, renewable energy, and the energy transition
- AI & Web3 Governance — AI regulation, blockchain law, DeFi, DAOs, and digital assets

RESEARCH & PORTFOLIO PUBLICATIONS

Title	Type	Date
AI-Generated Works and the Copyright Vacuum in Nigerian Law	Essay	Jan 2025
NDPA 2023: A Critical Review of Nigeria's New Data Protection Act	Analysis	Feb 2025
The Legal Vacuum Around Government Surveillance in Nigeria	Essay	Dec 2024
GDPR vs NDPA: What Nigeria Can Still Learn from Europe's Data Law Journey	Comparative	Oct 2024
The Lagos Court of Arbitration: Africa's Answer to London and Paris?	Analysis	Feb 2025
Nigeria and Investment Treaty Arbitration: Lessons from P&ID v. Nigeria	Comparative	Oct 2024
The Petroleum Industry Act 2021: Three Years On — What Changed?	Policy Analysis	Jan 2025
Nigeria's Energy Transition Plan: A Legal Analysis of the Regulatory Gaps	Essay	Nov 2024
Africa's Absence from Global AI Governance: Why the Continent Must Speak Now	Analysis	Feb 2025
CBN's Crypto U-Turn: From Ban to Regulation — Nigeria's Digital Asset Journey	Comparative	Oct 2024
Why Africa's Patent Problem is Really a Policy Problem	Opinion	Sep 2024
Protecting Nollywood: Trademark Dilution in Nigeria's Film Industry	Analysis	Nov 2024

ACTIVITIES & CONTRIBUTIONS

OAU Law Students' Society

Active Member
2023 – Present

Moot & Advocacy Simulations

Faculty arbitration, negotiation and client counselling exercises
2024 – Present

Substack — Reflections & Rants

Legal commentary and opinion writing · reflectionsandrants.substack.com
Ongoing

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Legal Research & Writing	Advanced
Policy Analysis & Drafting	Advanced
RegTech / LegalTech Literacy	Intermediate
Negotiation & Oral Advocacy	Intermediate

LANGUAGES

English (Professional proficiency) · Hausa (Native)

Full portfolio of essays, research projects, and domain work available at: abdullahishaq.vercel.app